

Menstruation Amidst COVID-19

Distribution of Sanitary Pads and Reusable Nose Masks to Girls in Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State, Nigeria

This project was implemented by Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF), the registered name of the organisation formerly known as Girls Health and Education Foundation (GHeF). GDGF was registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC), Nigeria in 2019. This report also documents the strategic evolution that led to Fly Girl 2020 — Green Menstruation, an initiative whose full implementation was disrupted by the COVID-19 pandemic.

Organisation	Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF)
Date	August 27, 2020
Location	Girls' secondary school, Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State, Nigeria
Beneficiaries	150 girls
Items Distributed	150 sanitary pads (Angel Pad) · reusable nose masks · disinfectants
Distinguished Guests	LGA Chairman, Kalgo LGA · state dignitaries · Nigeria Police (protocol)
Sponsors	Angel Pad · Benny & Freddy
Context	Menstrual Hygiene Day 2020 · #PeriodsInPandemics · COVID-19 pandemic period
Significance	First project under GDGF registered name · First project in Northern Nigeria

150 Girls Reached	3 Items Distributed (Pads, Masks, Disinfectant)	2 Sponsors	1st Project in Northern Nigeria
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Girls holding Angel Pad sanitary pads in front of the GDGF 'Menstruation Amidst COVID-19' banner at a girls' secondary school, Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State — August 27, 2020.

Strategic Context — From Fly Girl 2020 to COVID-19 Response

This project report covers two related elements of the Foundation's 2020 programming: first, the strategic evolution that produced Fly Girl 2020 — Green Menstruation; and second, the completed delivery of Menstruation Amidst COVID-19 in Kebbi State — the Foundation's direct response to the pandemic's impact on girls' menstrual health.

The M&E; Finding — Disposable Pads Are Not a Sustainable Solution

Following internal monitoring and evaluation across its programmes from 2016 to 2019, the Foundation's team identified a critical gap in its menstrual health model: distributing disposable sanitary pads, while addressing an immediate need, was not a sustainable solution. Disposable pads are a recurring cost that most girls and families in underserved communities cannot consistently afford; their distribution addresses a symptom rather than the underlying structural problem of period poverty.

The M&E; learning: Distributing disposable pads helps girls today. It does not help them next month, or next year. True menstrual health equity requires a solution girls can rely on long-term — without depending on NGO distribution cycles. This finding drove the Foundation's strategic pivot toward reusable menstrual products.

Fly Girl 2020 — Green Menstruation

In response to this evidence, the Foundation developed Fly Girl 2020 — Green Menstruation: an initiative to distribute 50,000 reusable sanitary pads to girls in underprivileged communities and schools across Nigeria. Reusable pads offer a sustainable, environmentally conscious alternative to disposable products — lasting up to two years with proper care, reducing both financial burden on families and environmental waste.

Fly Girl 2020 was designed, planned, and ready for implementation when the COVID-19 pandemic and associated lockdown restrictions made full rollout impossible. Schools were closed. Movement was restricted. Community gatherings were prohibited. The 50,000-pad distribution target could not be delivered as planned.

COVID-19 disruption — force majeure: *The non-implementation of Fly Girl 2020's full rollout was caused entirely by external factors — a global pandemic that closed schools and restricted all public gatherings across Nigeria. The Foundation's planning, design, and commitment to the programme remained intact. Fly Girl 2020 represents a strategic direction the Foundation is positioned to return to as conditions allow.*

Organisational Response — Adapt and Deliver

Rather than suspending all operations, the Foundation pivoted. Recognising that COVID-19 had introduced a new and compounding crisis for girls — periods do not stop during pandemics, but access to menstrual products becomes even more constrained when movement is restricted and supply chains are disrupted — the Foundation designed a COVID-responsive programme that combined menstrual health support with pandemic protection. The result was Menstruation Amidst COVID-19.

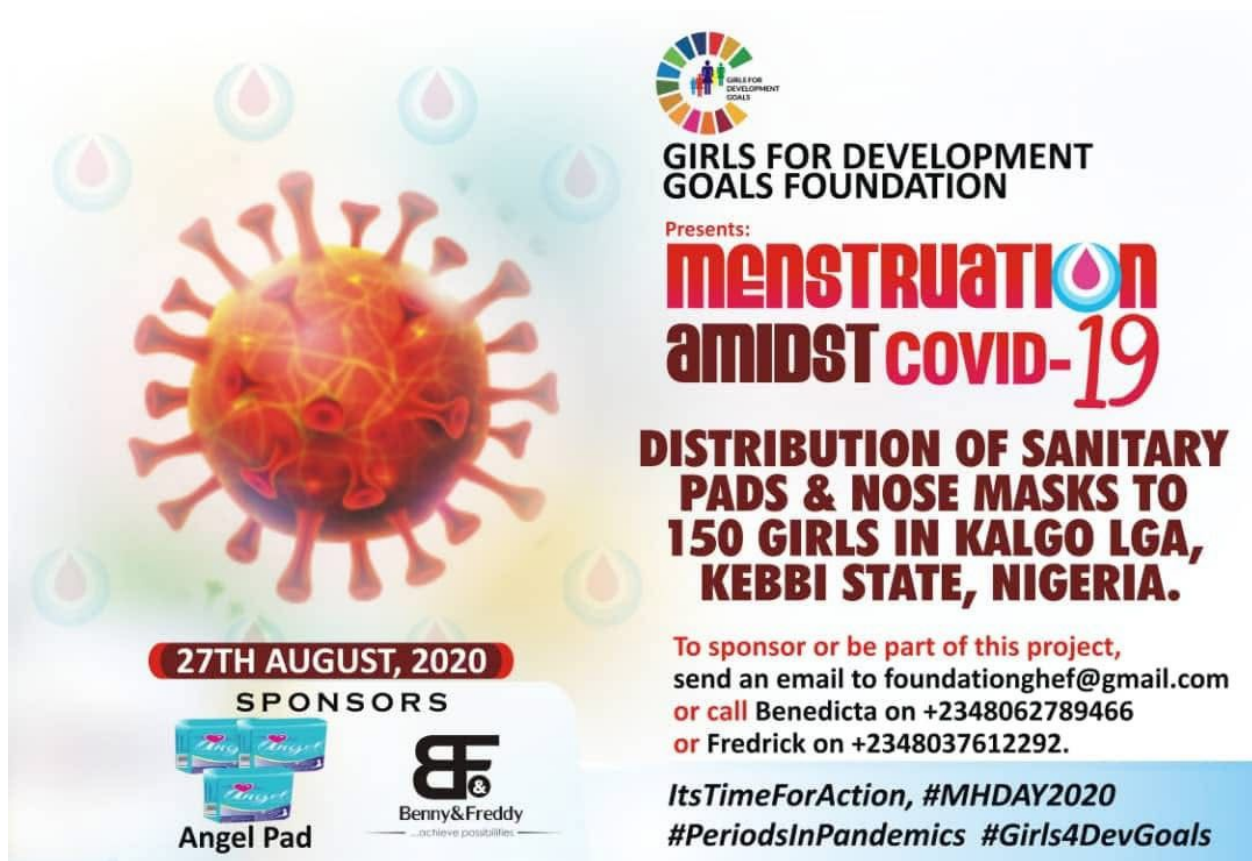
Executive Summary — Menstruation Amidst COVID-19

On August 27, 2020 — Menstrual Hygiene Day 2020 — Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF) implemented Menstruation Amidst COVID-19 at a girls' secondary school in Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State, Nigeria. The event distributed sanitary pads, reusable nose masks, and disinfectants to 150 girls, combining menstrual health support with direct COVID-19 protection measures.

The LGA Chairman of Kalgo and state dignitaries were present, alongside representatives of sponsor Angel Pad. Nigeria Police provided protocol. The event was held under the global theme of #PeriodsInPandemics — foregrounding the reality that menstruation does not pause during a health crisis, and that girls in underserved communities face compounded vulnerability when both menstrual products and protective equipment are inaccessible.

This project marks two organisational milestones: the first programme delivered under the Foundation's registered name Girls for Development Goals Foundation, and the Foundation's first intervention in Northern Nigeria — a significant geographical expansion from its Delta State origins.

Programme Documentation



Official event flyer — 'Menstruation Amidst COVID-19'. Girls for Development Goals Foundation. Distribution of Sanitary Pads & Nose Masks to 150 Girls in Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State, Nigeria. 27th August, 2020. Sponsors: Angel Pad · Benny & Freddy. Hashtags: #ItsTimeForAction #MHDAY2020 #PeriodsInPandemics #Girls4DevGoals.

Background and Context

The COVID-19 pandemic of 2020 created a compounding crisis for women and girls in low-income communities across Nigeria. School closures, movement restrictions, and economic disruption made already-scarce menstrual products even harder to access. At the same time, protective equipment — face masks and disinfectants — was in critical short supply in underserved communities, particularly in rural Northern Nigeria.

Periods in Pandemics: Research documented that 1 in 4 girls globally had difficulty accessing menstrual products during COVID-19 lockdowns. Supply chain disruptions, movement restrictions, and lost household income all contributed. Girls in underserved Northern Nigerian communities faced this crisis with the least access to alternatives.

Kebbi State in North-West Nigeria is among Nigeria's states with some of the most acute indicators of gender inequality and girls' education challenges. The Foundation's decision to expand its programming to this region — its first foray into Northern Nigeria — reflected a commitment to reaching the most underserved girls, not merely the most accessible.

Objectives

- Distribute sanitary pads to 150 girls in Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State during the COVID-19 pandemic, ensuring menstrual health needs were not deprioritised during the health crisis.

- Distribute reusable nose masks and disinfectants as direct COVID-19 protection for girls in an underserved community.
- Demonstrate the Foundation's operational resilience — delivering programming during a global pandemic under the #PeriodsInPandemics theme.
- Mark the Foundation's inaugural programme under its registered name, Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF).
- Expand the Foundation's geographic reach into Northern Nigeria for the first time.
- Sustain and deepen the Angel Pad corporate partnership through continued joint delivery.
- Secure LGA-level government endorsement in a new state and region.

Activities

Sanitary Pad Distribution

150 Angel Pad sanitary pad packs were distributed to girls at the school, addressing menstrual health needs that had become even more acute during the pandemic. Angel Pad representatives attended the event in branded uniforms, participating in the distribution ceremony.



Formal distribution ceremony — officials and dignitaries presenting sanitary pads and nose masks to girls on behalf of GDGF.



One-on-one distribution of sanitary pads to a girl in white hijab during the Menstruation Amidst COVID-19 event.

Nose Mask and Disinfectant Distribution

Reusable face masks and disinfectants were distributed alongside the sanitary pads — directly addressing COVID-19 vulnerability in a community where access to protective equipment was limited. This dual distribution model positioned GDGF as a holistic health partner to girls in Kebbi State, not merely a menstrual health provider.



*Distribution of sanitary pads and nose masks to a girl at the event
— Government Day Secondary School, Kalgo LGA.*



Angel Pad representative (in branded blue polo) with an event participant in front of the GDGF 'Menstruation Amidst COVID-19' banner.

Government Endorsement — LGA Chairman, Kalgo

The LGA Chairman of Kalgo and other state dignitaries were present at the event and participated in the formal distribution ceremony. Nigeria Police provided protocol, reflecting the official recognition of the event. The LGA Chairman's presence continued the Foundation's consistent record of securing government-level endorsement for its programmes — from Ukwuani LGA in Delta State in 2017 to Kalgo LGA in Kebbi State in 2020.



Group photo with dignitaries and team — LGA Chairman (in blue kaftan and cap), Angel Pad representative, and state officials in front of GDGF banner.



LGA Chairman formally presenting sanitary pads to a student during the distribution ceremony — GDGF banner visible behind.



Nigeria Police officer providing protocol at the event — confirming government and security presence at the GDGF programme in Kebbi State.



Officials and dignitaries at the event — COVID banner visible, confirming the public health context of the programme.

Student Attendance and Engagement

Girls assembled in orderly lines outside and inside the school building, wearing white hijabs consistent with the school's dress code. Many students wore face masks, reflecting pandemic safety protocols. Photographs confirm significant student participation and an organised, structured distribution process.



Girls assembled outside the school in white hijabs ahead of the distribution — Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State.



Girls lined up outside the school in uniform — confirming the scale of student attendance at the event.

Beneficiaries

Category	Details
Girls reached	150
Location	Girls' secondary school, Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State, Nigeria
Items received	Sanitary pads (Angel Pad) · reusable nose masks · disinfectants
Government endorsement	LGA Chairman, Kalgo LGA — present and participated in distribution
Sponsors	Angel Pad · Benny & Freddy
Protocol	Nigeria Police — present
Organisation	Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF) — first event under registered name
Geographic significance	First GDGF programme in Northern Nigeria
Date	August 27, 2020 (Menstrual Hygiene Day 2020)
Cumulative reach 2016–2020	3,950+ individuals across 4 completed programmes

Results and Impact

Operational resilience during a global pandemic

While the full Fly Girl 2020 initiative could not be delivered due to COVID-19, the Foundation did not stand down. Within the constraints of the pandemic, GDGF designed, funded, and delivered a COVID-responsive programme — reaching 150 girls in one of Nigeria's most underserved regions on Menstrual Hygiene Day 2020.

First delivery under the GDGF registered name

This project marked the first programme implemented under the Foundation's officially registered identity — Girls for Development Goals Foundation — representing a formal transition from a grassroots initiative to a registered Nigerian civil society organisation with CAC status.

Geographic expansion into Northern Nigeria

The Kebbi State programme represented the Foundation's first intervention in Northern Nigeria — a region with distinct cultural, religious, and socioeconomic contexts that required a specifically adapted approach. Reaching girls in Kalgo LGA demonstrated that GDGF's model was not limited to its Delta State origins.

Dual health intervention — menstrual health and COVID-19 protection

By distributing sanitary pads, nose masks, and disinfectants together, the Foundation addressed two simultaneous health vulnerabilities in a single programme. This integrated approach reflected a sophisticated understanding of the compounding health challenges facing girls during the pandemic.

Continued government partnership

Securing the LGA Chairman's presence and participation in Kebbi State — a new region with no prior Foundation relationship — demonstrated GDGF's growing national credibility and its ability to build government partnerships across Nigeria's diverse political landscape.

Angel Pad partnership deepened

Angel Pad's continued sponsorship and physical attendance — from their first appearance at Project Dry in Delta State in 2017 to Kebbi State in 2020 — confirms a durable multi-year corporate partnership built on shared mission and demonstrated community impact.

Photo Gallery

Selected photographs from Menstruation Amidst COVID-19, Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State, August 27, 2020.



Girls lined up for distribution outside the school.



Angel Pad representative with a student in front of GDGF banner.



Officials and team at the formal ceremony — GDGF banner visible.



Team members with girls during distribution — police visible in background.

Angel Pad representative and participant at the event.

Group photo with LGA Chairman and state dignitaries.

All photographs are used for project reporting and accountability purposes.

Challenges and Learning

The COVID-19 pandemic prevented the full implementation of Fly Girl 2020 — Green Menstruation. The 50,000 reusable pad distribution target remains an active strategic ambition for the Foundation as pandemic restrictions ease and school-based programming becomes feasible at scale again.

Operating in Northern Nigeria for the first time required cultural sensitivity and community-specific relationship building. The programme's success in Kebbi State demonstrates that this can be done — and provides a foundation for future Northern Nigeria programming.

Pandemic-period logistics — procurement, transport, and gathering restrictions — significantly constrained the scale of delivery. The 150-girl reach, while meaningful, represents a fraction of the Foundation's normal operating capacity.

The name of the host school was not formally recorded in programme documentation. Full venue details, including school name and enrolment figures, should be captured in future event records.

Contextual Data — COVID-19 and Menstrual Health (2020)

Indicator	Figure	Source
Girls globally with difficulty accessing menstrual products during COVID-19	1 in 4	Plan International, 2020
Nigerian girls without sanitary pad access (pre-COVID baseline)	~37%	UNICEF / PMC
Kebbi State — female literacy rate	Among lowest in Nigeria	NBS Nigeria
Nigeria COVID-19 lockdown period	March–June 2020 (first wave)	NCDC Nigeria

Menstrual Hygiene Day 2020 theme	#PeriodsInPandemics	WASH United
Reusable pad lifespan	Up to 2 years with proper care	UNICEF WASH
Cost saving — reusable vs disposable pads (annually)	Up to 85% reduction in cost	PMC Period Poverty Study

The case for Fly Girl 2020: A reusable pad lasts up to two years and can reduce a family's annual menstrual health cost by up to 85%. Distributing 50,000 reusable pads — the Fly Girl 2020 target — would have provided up to two years of menstrual protection for 50,000 girls without requiring repeat procurement. This remains the Foundation's strategic ambition.

Partners and Acknowledgements

- Angel Pad — for continuing sponsorship and branded presence at the event
- Benny & Freddy — for financial sponsorship of the programme
- LGA Chairman, Kalgo LGA — for his presence and participation in the distribution
- State dignitaries of Kebbi State — for their support and attendance
- Nigeria Police — for providing protocol
- The host school, Kalgo LGA — for facilitating the event
- The 150 girls of Kalgo LGA, Kebbi State — who received support during one of the most challenging periods in recent history

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